The curriculum changes that course counts miss

20 universities in the historical panel. Six institutions examined in depth. A source-backed look at what changes inside curriculum documents.

MIT

LLMs appear inside an existing software design course

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON

A broad mathematics choice becomes two specified fields

UNIVERSITY OF EDINBURGH

A project requirement expands into a choice, then narrows

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY

The AI requirement persists while its named options change

UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO

An explicit alternative was already allowed in the earlier catalogue

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO, ST GEORGE

An existing deep learning course enters an activity's option list

What is measured: published requirements, catalogue language and documented choice rules. What remains unverified: classroom implementation, student uptake and learning outcomes.

MIT / COURSE DESCRIPTION

LLMs appear inside an existing software design course

The verified 2026/27 description of 6.1040 Software Design explicitly includes using LLMs in design and coding. The 2024/25 description already covered software design and individual and team projects, but did not state this LLM component.

A catalogue can document a change within an established course without introducing a new course name or code.

Scope: 6.1040 is a track/advanced-subject option, not individually required for every 6-3 student. These pages do not date the first classroom use of LLMs; 2025/26 was not sampled. Current tables also disagree on its units.

Source: 2024/25 course catalogue
Source: Verified 2026/27 course catalogue
Source: Current subject groupings and roles

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON / REQUIREMENT STRUCTURE

A broad mathematics choice becomes two specified fields

The 2023/24 CS BS catalogue required two additional mathematics courses totalling at least six credits from a broad list. The 2024/25 edition separates this into one linear algebra choice and one probability or statistics choice. The verified 2026/27 rules retain that structure.

The change is in the required combination of subject areas. Courses such as MATH 340 and STAT 324 appear on both sides.

Scope: Neither named course is individually compulsory. Historical editions are end-of-year Summer archives. The evidence bounds the document change, not its implementation date, affected cohorts or cause; mathematics is not automatically labelled AI.

Source: 2023/24 CS BS requirements
Source: 2024/25 CS BS requirements
Source: Verified 2026/27 requirements

UNIVERSITY OF EDINBURGH / CHOICE AND EXCEPTION RULES

A project requirement expands into a choice, then narrows

The 2022/23 CS BSc listed System Design Project individually as compulsory. In 2023/24 and 2024/25, students could satisfy a 20-credit group with that course or Entrepreneurship and Innovation Project. The 2026/27 rules again list System Design Project individually, retaining an approved Formula Student substitution.

Requiring project work and requiring one specific project course are different constraints. The observed sequence is not a one-way expansion of choice.

Scope: The unsampled 2025/26 edition leaves the first year of the return unresolved. The alternative project's 2026/27 catalogue marks it not being delivered; this does not establish permanent closure or actual teaching outcomes.

Source: 2022/23 CS BSc requirements
Source: 2023/24 CS BSc requirements
Source: 2026/27 CS BSc requirements

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY / STABLE CATEGORY, CHANGING MEMBERSHIP

The AI requirement persists while its named options change

All four observed CS BS editions retain one AI-category elective worth at least nine CMU units. The 2026/27 named list includes 07-280 and 10-301, while 15-281 is absent from that list. A description for 15-281 remains in the current course catalogue.

A stable category requirement can coexist with changed membership. Absence from one qualifying list is not evidence of a course closing.

Scope: These are catalogue editions with different stated entry-cohort applicability, not a common cohort panel. Unsampled years remain. The list also includes a Qatar-only annotated option; it is not a Pittsburgh teaching inventory.

Source: 2022/23 CS BS curriculum
Source: 2026/27 CS BS curriculum
Source: Current SCS course descriptions

UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO / APPARENT CHANGE RESOLVED

An explicit alternative was already allowed in the earlier catalogue

The 2023/24 BCS table explicitly lists CS 240E and CS 241E as alternatives where the 2022/23 table named CS 240 and CS 241. Yet the 2022/23 course descriptions already permitted those enriched courses to substitute wherever their standard counterparts were required.

Reading the programme table alone would overstate the change. Joining it to course notes identifies an explicit restatement of an existing permission.

Scope: The finding covers these two course pairs only. Entry restrictions and prerequisites still apply. It does not establish identical student access, actual delivery or the quality of enriched instruction.

Source: 2022/23 BCS requirements
Source: 2023/24 BCS requirements
Source: 2022/23 CS course descriptions and substitution notes

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO, ST GEORGE / EXPLICIT ELIGIBILITY

An existing deep learning course enters an activity's option list

The CS Major's 2023/24 integrative inquiry-based activity list adds CSC 413H1, alongside CSC 302H1. Both courses already existed in the 2022/23 catalogue. CSC 413H1 already described neural networks and related methods; its description body was unchanged in 2023/24.

The observed change concerns explicit membership in a requirement's eligible list. It is not the creation of the course or a universal deep learning requirement.

Scope: Other course routes and ASIP can satisfy the activity. The claim concerns this major and this list, not all degree requirements or inherited internship entitlements. Actual delivery and student choices remain unverified.

Source: 2022/23 Arts & Science Calendar: major and course entries
Source: 2023/24 Arts & Science Calendar: major and course entries